

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: An unexpected career change.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Have you or anyone in your family changed careers? Why?
- If you had the opportunity to start a new career, what would it be?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about rules, regulations and decision-making.
- I can express possibility and necessity.
- I can organize points in an argument.





Let's Explore!

Sally is about to embark on a new career path. Do you think she's ready to **take the plunge***?

* To "take the plunge" means to begin something new, usually after hesitation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Thank you for meeting me today on such short notice.
- College Counselor:** Happy I could squeeze you in!
- Sally:** I'm about to register for your Floral Arranging Diploma. I thought I had better speak to someone about my job prospects once I complete the course.
- College Counselor:** That's a great question. First, you might want to think seriously about this move into floristry. Designing bouquets will not make you wealthy. You must take that into consideration before you take the plunge.
- Sally:** I'm ready for a career change. I'm not getting the personal satisfaction out of it that I used to.
- College Counselor:** Also, our courses are organized into modules. There's an online component. Are you familiar with online applications?
- Sally:** Oh yes, I'm currently working as a journalist for Cambridge Life.
- College Counselor:** Perfect!
- Sally:** Do you think I ought to speak with a couple local florists to get their take on the industry?
- College Counselor:** Absolutely! You might make some new contacts.
- Sally:** Registration forms should be completed online, correct?
- College Counselor:** Your application must be sent via mail to the admissions department.
- Sally:** Oh, I see. I heard that it's very popular.
- College Counselor:** Everything is taken into account. In fact, your previous work experience can also be included with your other documents to improve your chances of admission.
- Sally:** Great! There might be a risk but I think it's the right option for me.
- College Counselor:** Indeed, everything should be considered before embarking on a new career path.



Let's Practice!

Sally and the college counselor talk about what Sally must do for applying to floristry.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. had / I / prospects / course. / job / once / better / someone / to / my / about / the / I / speak / complete

2. want / move / to / You / into / about / floristry / . / think / this / might

3. the / take / think / florists / ought / I / industry? / with / local / you / a / Do / get / to / speak / couple / to / on / their

4. you / the / You / take / that / must / into / take / before / plunge / consideration / .

5. admissions / Your / via / department. / must / mail / to / the / your / application / send





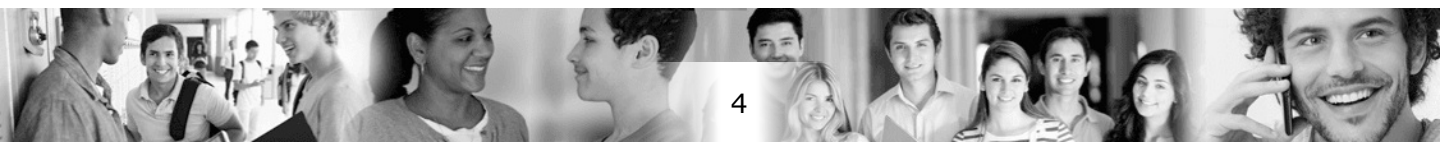
Let's Practice!

Sally talks about the decision she made.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the expressions provided in a way they are coherent.

- however
- In spite of
- In fact
- there for
- Therefore
- should
- First
- secondly

1. _____, you might want to think seriously about this move into floristry.
After doing so, you can register.
2. Everything is taken into account. _____, your previous work experience can also be included with your other documents to improve your chances of admission.
3. I know you're really excited about studying floristry; _____, everything should be considered before embarking on a new career path.
4. _____ getting a lower salary in floristry, I'm ready for a career change.
5. Designing bouquets will not make you wealthy. _____, you must take that into consideration before you take the plunge.





Extension Activity

Write a thank-you letter to a friend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about what is important to you in a friend.
- Make a list of adjectives to describe the behavior of a good friend.
- Imagine that a friend has helped you to make an important decision.
- Write a letter to your friend thanking them for being such a good friend.
- Use at least 6 adjectives from your list to describe your friend and include examples of these qualities.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about activities and decision-making.

☐ ☐

I speculate about things, people and events.

☐ ☐

I make a list of adjectives to describe personality.

☐ ☐

I write a letter to thank a friend.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to squeeze one in** (expression): to make room for someone or something in a tight schedule or space
e.g. I'm happy I could squeeze you in, because there were not many spots left.
- **module** (noun): a small unit of education that develops one topic
e.g. Our courses are organized into modules
- **to embark** (verb): to start something new
e.g. You should consider everything before embarking on a new career.
- **admissions department** (noun): the office in a learning institution that is in charge of deciding who is accepted or not
e.g. Your application must be sent via mail to the admissions department.
- **component** (noun): a part or division of something
e.g. There's an online component that you need to submit.
- **take** (noun): the amount collected out of something, generally in terms of money
e.g. Do you think I ought to speak with a couple local florists to get their take on the industry?





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility, Necessity and To Give Advice

You use modals when you want to express possibility and necessity. It can also be used to give advice.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

**Might* suggests that something is less possible than *may*.

- *might* / *might not* + infinitive
- *could* / *could not* + infinitive
- *may* / *may not* + infinitive

Expressing Necessity

You use *must* or *have to* to express that something is necessarily true.

Example:

I have to bite the bullet and commit to this.

You use the modal verbs *should*, *ought to* and *had better* to express that they think something is a good or a bad idea.

Should is the most common way to give advice.

Passive with Modals

There are two basic patterns you use for passive modals.

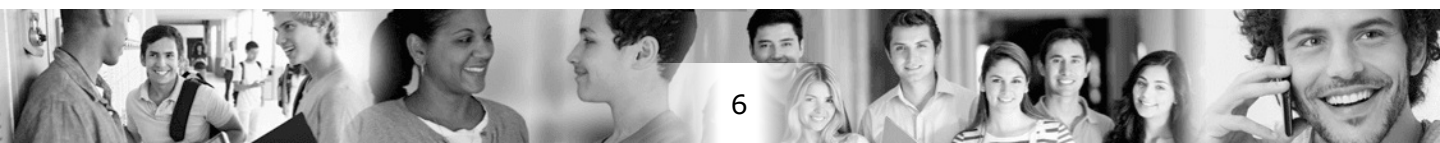
modal + *be* + past participle

and

modal + *have been* + past participle

Examples:

- *Causes and effects must be considered over and over again to make the right decision.*
- *You ought to think on the consequences for your life.*
- *I thought I had better speak to someone about my job prospects once I complete the course.*
- *You must take that into consideration before you take the plunge.*





Learning Points

Organizing Points in an Argument

You use words or phrases to organize ideas in a piece of writing.

Discourse markers show how ideas are connected. They usually come at the beginning of a sentence.

Discourse markers can show a **connection** to what the writer is saying and what was just written. They can also show what the writer's **opinion** is about what is being discussed.

Look at the chart for some common discourse markers and their meanings:

Discourse Marker (Linking Word)	Meaning
<i>However</i>	<i>But</i> ; Contrast
<i>Therefore</i>	Logical consequence
<i>In spite of</i>	Emphasizing a contrast
<i>What is more</i>	Adding
<i>Of course</i>	Stating it is obvious
<i>In fact</i>	Emphasizing and adding

Examples:

- *Firstly, you might want to think seriously about this move into floristry.*
- *Also, our courses are organized into modules.*
- *Indeed, everything should be considered before embarking on a new career path.*

